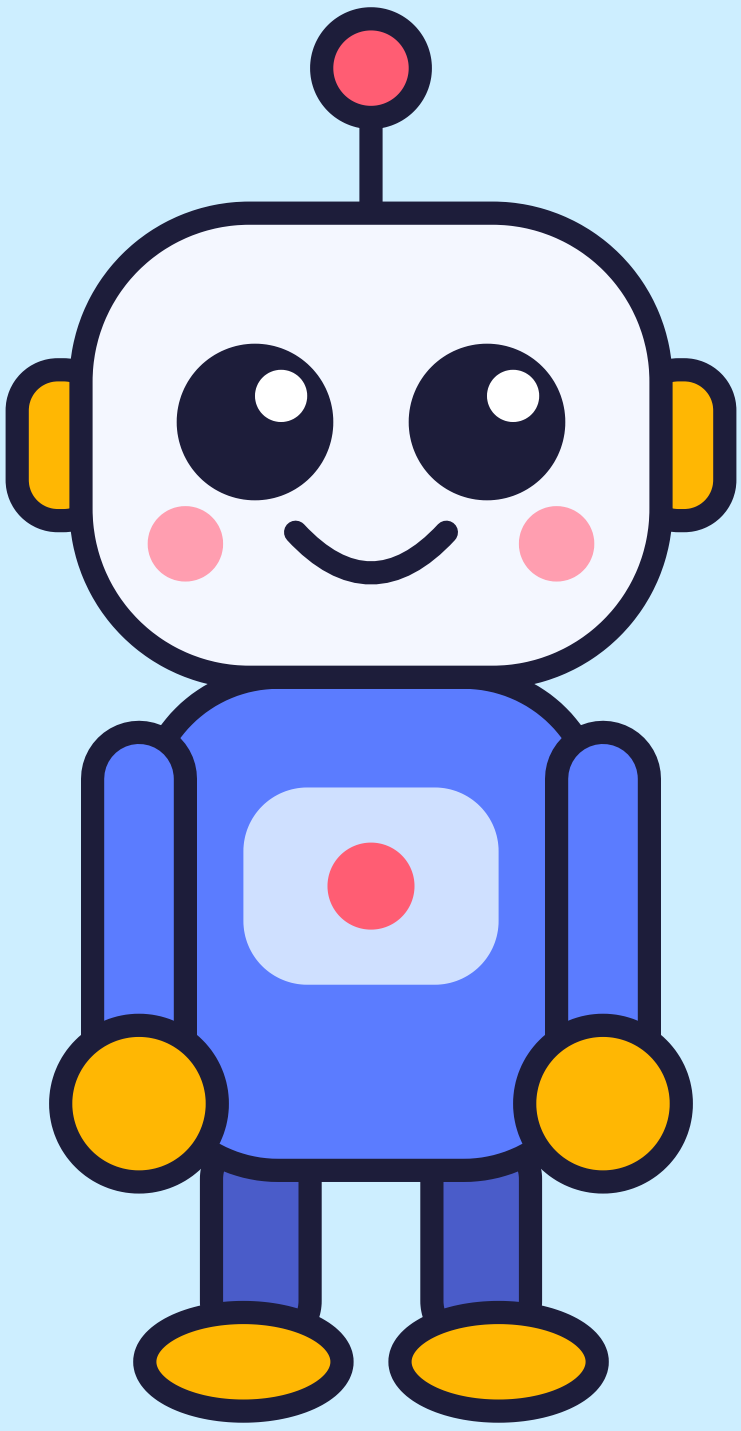
I gave an AI agent a wallet.





ms per paid call

median of 25 runs, 200 ms blocks

test chain, test money

HOW IT WORKS

Ask, get a 402, sign, done.

Agent host
holds the wallet and the spending caps

calls get_quote over WebMCP

Web page
registers the tool with document.modelContext

fetch /api/quote gets **402 + price**

Wallet bridge
host signs an EIP-3009 authorization (2.1 ms)

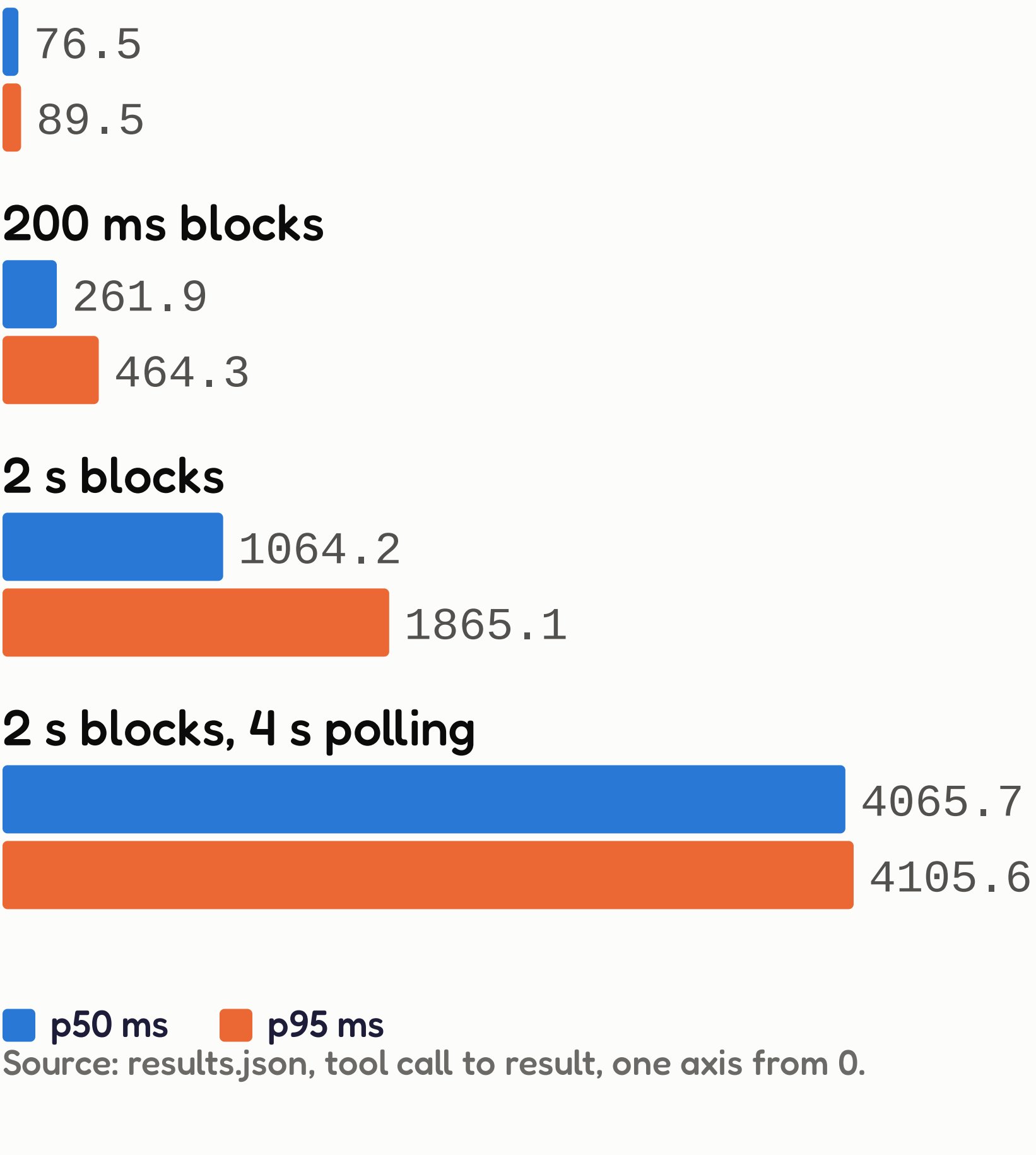
retry with PAYMENT-SIGNATURE

Merchant + facilitator
verify, settle on chain, return 200 + result

The page never holds a key.

LATENCY, 25 RUNS PER ROW

Almost all the time is the chain.



Source: results.json, tool call to result, one axis from 0.

WHERE 262 MS GOES (200 MS BLOCKS, P50)

Settling is the slow bit.

Facilitator settle	234.9 ms
Facilitator verify	16.9 ms
Wallet sign	2.1 ms
Tool discovery (getTools)	1.3 ms

The WebMCP part costs about 1 ms. Block time sets the rest.

Source: results.json. Discovery figure from README.

THE GOTCHA

One library default. 3 seconds gone. Classic.

2 s blocks, receipt polling 200 ms

1 064 ms

same chain, viem default 4 s polling

4 066 ms

viem looks for a receipt every 4 s. My payment sat there waiting for the poll, not the block.

```
pollingInterval: 200
```

Median tool call, 25 runs each. Source: results.json.

REAL VS TEST

What is real, what is pretend.

Real

- Chromium 158.0.8127.18 with native WebMCP
- Official x402 SDK 2.30.0
- EIP-712 signing, on-chain transfer
- Spend caps and replay protection

Test

- Local ganache chain
- Own test token, not USDC
- Facilitator runs on loopback
- A script, not an LLM
- The wallet bridge is my own hack

A hosted facilitator and a real RPC add round trips I did not measure.

THE OPEN PROBLEM

Who holds the agent's wallet?

WebMCP has no wallet hook. The page can ask for money. Somebody else has to sign. I do not know who yet.

- The browser
- The model vendor
- You

Every demo I found keeps the key in the page or its server.

RUN IT YOURSELF

Go break it.

github.com/Egoushka/x402-webm
cp-lab

```
npm install
npm test
```

MIT. Code, method, raw numbers. Four scenarios, 25 runs each.

Who should hold the wallet? Tell me in the comments.